Haribabu's father had made up his mind. He was not going to keep quiet despite a note of caution from his wife. He had gone to meet Ragothaman at the SIT's office in Malligai. He handed Ragothaman a camera tripod and said it belonged to his son. Maybe the cop could find some fingerprints on it? It was thoughtful of the father. Ragothaman had not expected it. He, however, noticed a certain reluctance about the man—maybe he wanted to say something.

'Is there anything else you want to tell me? Please feel free.'

'No, no, sir. That's it, that's it. Give me permission to leave, sir.'

Ragothaman asked Chelladurai to drop Haribabu's father home. 'Please wait outside,' he said. 'My assistant will soon join you.'

The father stepped out. He still looked hesitant about something.

'I believe he wanted to say something to me when I went to his house the other day, but his wife was stopping him. Survey his house when you go to drop him—clandestinely, of course,' Ragothaman told his assistant before they left.

Verma and Ragothaman raided Haribabu's hut the next day. After dropping the father the previous night, Chelladurai had telephoned Ragothaman and claimed that there were bundles of plain paper in the three adjoining huts next to Haribabu's father's for printing books and journals. The family owned these huts as well—two had been recently acquired. Locals, too, had noticed their sudden financial rise, Chelladurai had said. Ragothaman advised Chelladurai to call for additional forces and maintain a watch on the huts that night—nobody should be allowed into the huts until the next morning.

In the raid, the SIT found, among other suspicious things, the original bill of the Tamil Nadu state emporium, Poompuhar, on Anna Salai Road, dated 21 May 1991, for the purchase of a sandalwood garland for sixty-nine rupees. This could be the same garland the assassin had been seen carrying in her hand in Haribabu's photograph. It was undoubtedly a breakthrough in the investigation. Anirudhya could not cover the raid due to a change in its timing but he got the dope he needed.